YOUR PARENTING PROFILE



The Cronut

P G T E

Knows the rules well enough to remix them.

Your four letters

Your code is built from four research-backed parenting dimensions. Neither pole of any dimension is the better one.



P — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY
Planner

G — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION
Gardener

T — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG
Talker

E — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE
Explorer

For fun & reflection — not a clinical assessment or diagnostic tool.

AN EVERYDAY STORY

The Volcano That Became a Dinosaur

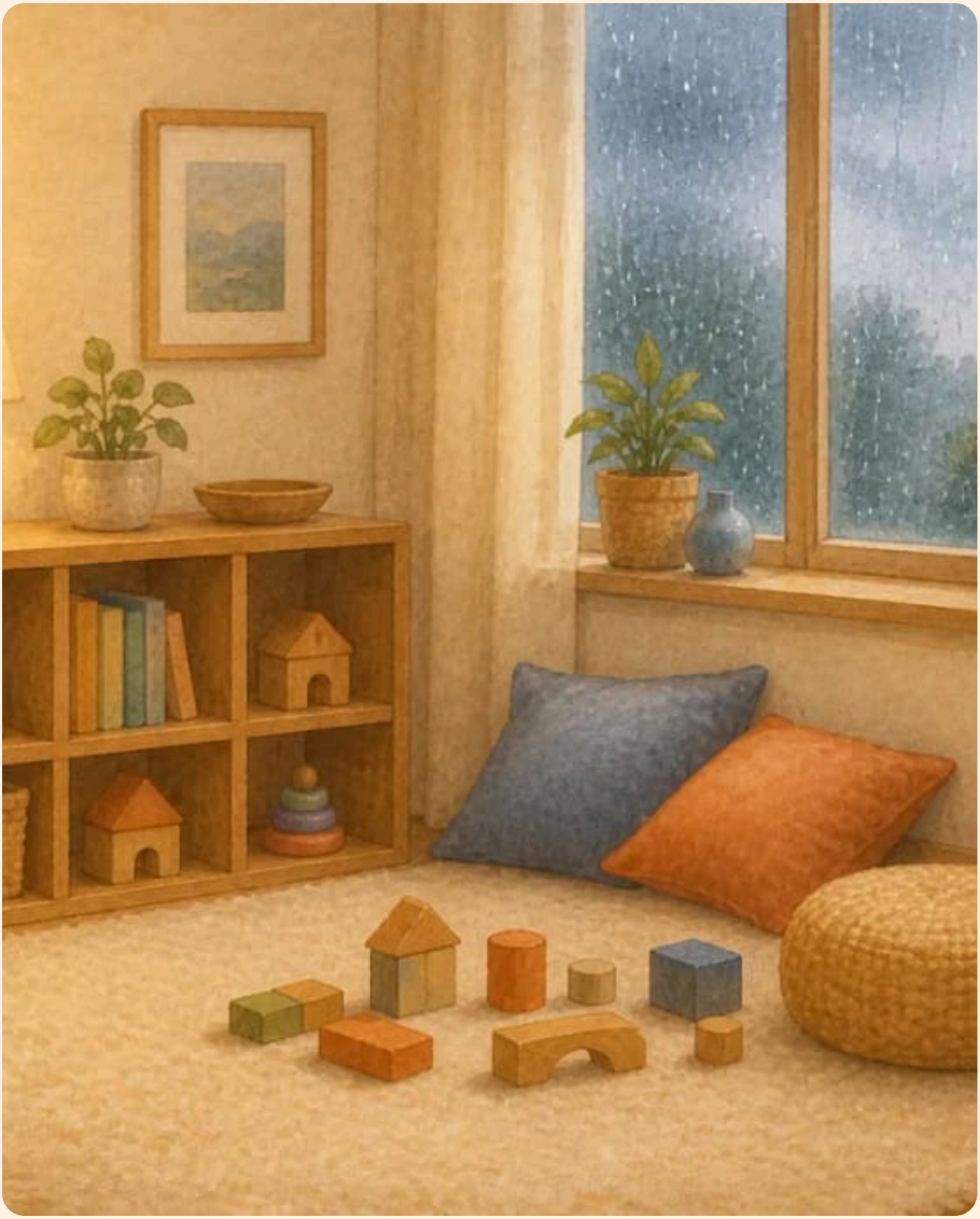
The dining table still holds baking soda, red paint, and half a cardboard volcano when your child runs in carrying a dinosaur book. “Can we make this one next?” Yesterday you were just as excited as they were. Today, seeing three unfinished experiments and a message from work, you hear yourself think: We never finish anything. I keep creating chaos.

As a Cronut parent, you understand the recipe and immediately want to remix it. Curiosity in your home grows fast, crosses categories, and rarely asks permission before changing direction. That is not failure. Sometimes a question is complete the moment wonder has been satisfied.



Before making another plan, you take fifteen minutes with your own sketchbook, no lesson, no photo, no output. Then you return with three choices: finish, save, or let go.

Your child chooses to photograph the volcano and recycle it. The dinosaur can wait until tomorrow. The table is not perfectly clear, but one story has an ending. You have shown that exploring does not mean keeping everything forever, and that your own play deserves space too.



WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS

You quickly catch your child's newest obsession and want to turn it into a rich experience. A pile of half-finished projects can make you feel inconsistent.

RELEASE THE GUILT

Curiosity does not always need a finished product. A changing interest is not proof you failed to follow through; sometimes exploration ends when the question has been answered.



YOUR SUPERPOWERS

1. You go all-in on your kid's current obsession
2. Feelings get named in this house
3. You make learning feel like invention

WATCH-OUT, WITH LOVE

So many experiments, so little follow-through. Finish one recipe before starting three. 🍩

YOUR POP-CULTURE COUSIN

Montessori-inspired experimenter



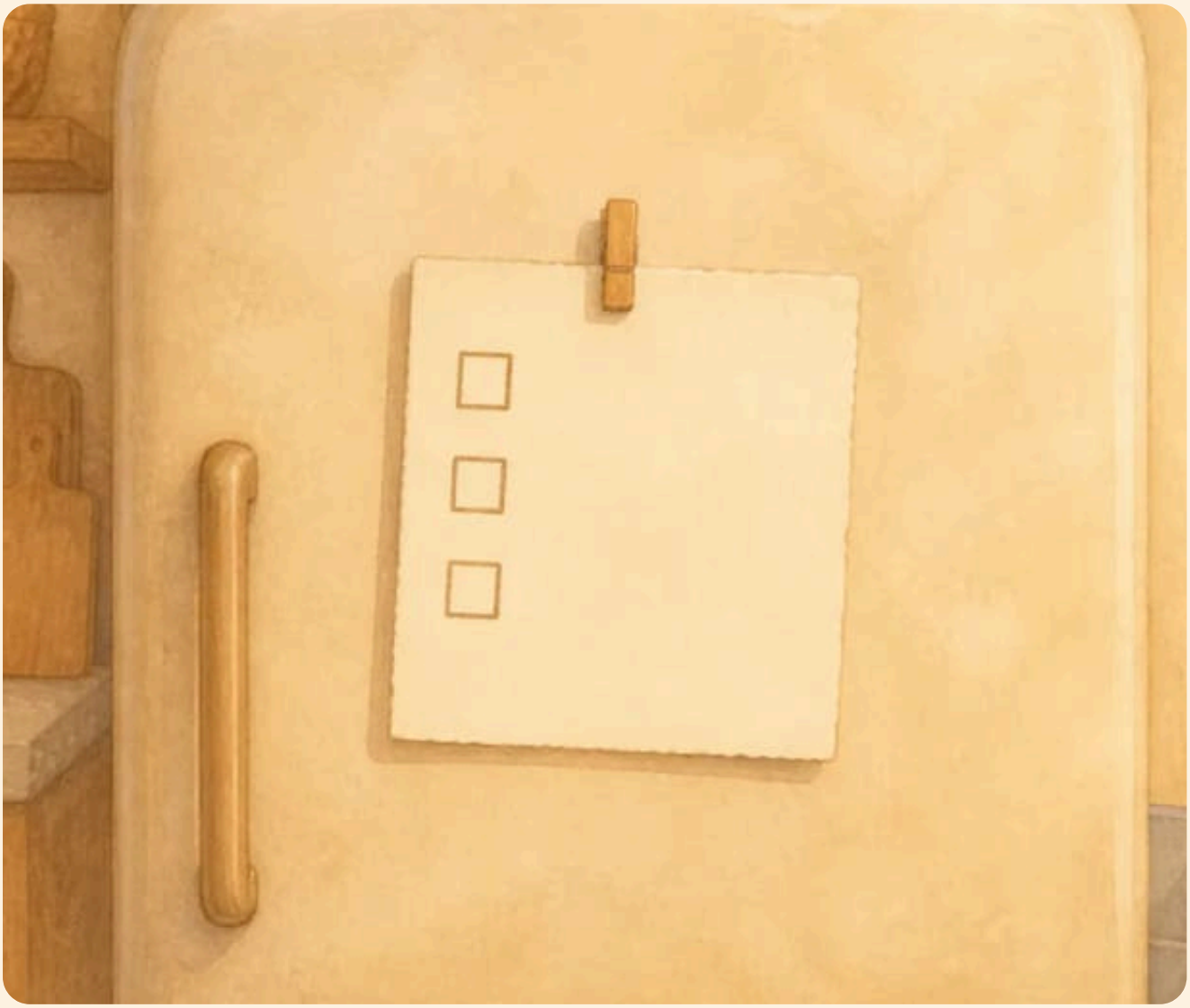
WHAT TO REMEMBER

Try this week

- [ ] Choose one project to finish or release
- [ ] Play creatively for 15 minutes just for you
- [ ] Ask: “Do we continue, store it, or finish here?”

EXTRAS FOR YOUR STYLE

- [ ] Let one plan change without correcting it.
- [ ] Set one limit and hold it to the end.
- [ ] After you name the feeling, stay quiet for ten seconds before anything else.
- [ ] Stop at the first try if they say that's enough.



FOR YOU FIRST

5 ways to come back to yourself

Chosen from your style: what you spend yourself on is what needs releasing. Not one of these is for your child.

There's an order most of us have backwards: everyone else gets looked after first, and you get whatever is left. But what's left at nine at night isn't you — it's the part of you that never got to rest.

The next five pages don't ask you to be a better parent. Nothing here is counted, nothing is reported, and not one of them is for your child. They're all for you, and they aren't a reward you have to earn first.

What's on them isn't random either. Every parenting style spends itself differently: some parents run out from anticipating, some from deciding, some from holding everybody's feelings. So whatever drains you most is also what most needs releasing.



WHAT DRAINS YOU MOST

P

HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY

Anticipating. Your head keeps running even when your body sits down.

G

WHO SETS THE DIRECTION

Waiting and holding back. Following someone else's pace all day is work.

T

WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG

Absorbing feelings. Your ears have been on shift since morning.

E

COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE

Being the energy. Every bit of the fun sets off from you first.

FOR YOU FIRST

Do one creative thing that does not become a child activity, content, or a target. You are allowed to play too.

HOW TO USE THESE

Take just one. If only one of these gets used this week, that worked. The rest stay here; they aren't going anywhere.

No time this week? You are still enough.



TIME 5 MIN

One drink while it's still hot

Almost every parent drinks their coffee cold. Not from lack of time, but because there is always one more thing that comes first.

Sit down. Finish the whole thing at its actual temperature, doing nothing else at the same time.



TIME 2 MIN

One unplanned thing

Not to train spontaneity. Just small proof to yourself that a moment off-plan is survivable.

Do one small thing today that was on no list. A different route home, an unscheduled snack.



TIME 5 MIN

Rehearse one limit sentence

Following the child still needs a floor under it. A limit is easier to say once you've heard it in your own voice.

Say one clear limit out loud, alone, until it sounds normal: "Not today." "I need ten minutes."



TIME 5 MIN

Write it, don't say it

Not everything you feel needs to become a conversation. Some of it just needs to get out.

Write one sentence nobody will read, and don't process it with anyone today.



TIME 10 MIN

Sit still in one spot

You are usually everyone's source of energy. Sitting outside without going anywhere refills something a new activity can't.

Outside, one place, no walking anywhere. Find five things you can see without moving.

5 activities with your child (0–5)

One for each age range, so you can take the one that fits your child right now. Everything is already in your house.



THEN, FOR YOUR CHILD

Your child benefits from freedom to explore and from seeing a simple way to close, store, or release a project.



0–12 MONTHS · 10 MIN

Just out of reach

Babies learn movement from effort, not from being handed things. That small gap is where the trying happens.

1. Lay your baby on a firm, flat surface.
2. Put one interesting object a hand's width past their fingers.
3. Say nothing and wait, even when it takes a while. Don't slide it closer.

You'll need: One object with texture or a soft sound.

Safety first: Firm surface, never a bed or a sofa edge. The object must be too big to pass through a toilet-paper tube.

Grounded in: Montessori — freedom of movement



1–2 YEARS · 10 MIN

In, out, again

Repetition isn't boredom to a toddler — it's how they confirm the world is predictable.

1. Cut one hand-sized hole in a box lid, or use a wide-mouth jar.
2. Show it once, slowly, then hand it over.
3. Let them repeat it far past the point where you're bored.

You'll need: A box or wide jar, plus large objects: jar lids, blocks, wooden rings.

Safety first: Every object larger than a toilet-paper tube, and no cut edges on the hole.

Grounded in: Montessori — order



2–3 YEARS · 10 MIN

Sort it your way

You supply the objects; they supply the rule. Their rule is the point.

1. Tip out 10–15 mixed household objects and two empty bowls.
2. Say "you can sort these however you like", then stay quiet.
3. If they sort by something you'd never have chosen, that's the successful version.

You'll need: Large buttons, bottle caps, spoons, blocks, socks.

Safety first: Every object must be too large for a toilet-paper tube and have no sharp edges. An adult stays with them.

Grounded in: Montessori — sensorial



3–4 YEARS · 20 MIN

Special play time

This is the weekly session used in filial therapy, run by the parent at home. If you try only one activity in this booklet, make it this one.

1. 20 minutes, one child, a consistent time and place, phone in another room.
2. They choose everything. You follow, and join in only when invited — no teaching, no questions, no suggestions.
3. Describe what you see ("You're giving the baby a bottle"), reflect what they feel ("That surprised you"), and praise the effort, never the result ("You kept trying until you got it").
4. Give a five-minute and a one-minute warning before you stop.

You'll need: Simple non-mechanical things: paper and crayons, a doll, animals, blocks, cars.

Safety first: Use intact, age-appropriate toys with no loose batteries or small parts. An adult stays in the room.

Grounded in: Filial therapy — special play time



4–5 YEARS · 15 MIN

A treasure map of our house

Drawing a map and then following it is symbolic thinking with legs.

1. They draw a map of a room, however inaccurate.
2. Hide a small soft toy or block together and mark it.
3. Follow their map, not your knowledge of the house.

You'll need: Paper, crayons, one small soft toy or block to hide.

Safety first: Agree which rooms are in play. If a child under three lives in the home, choose an object too large for a toilet-paper tube.

Grounded in: Montessori — order



No play today? You are still enough.

Keep it, print it, or forget it

This booklet has no targets and counts nothing. Take the one thing that helps and leave the rest.



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